DATA ANALYSIS · STARTUP ACQUISITION INTELLIGENCE

The TrustMRR Startup Landscape

Where revenue, growth, and acquisition value concentrate across 1,000 indie SaaS listings — and where the numbers disagree with where founders are building.

Executive Summary

The headline numbers behind this analysis

1,000 Startups analyzed	**65 / 29** Countries / categories represented	**$282** Median MRR
$13,472 Average MRR — 48x the median	**26%** Currently listed for sale	**6** Listings that are both cheap and growing

The gap between a $282 median and a $13,472 average MRR is the whole story: a handful of breakout startups skew every raw average in this dataset. Every comparison in this deck uses medians, and reports sample size wherever it drops below 15 listings.

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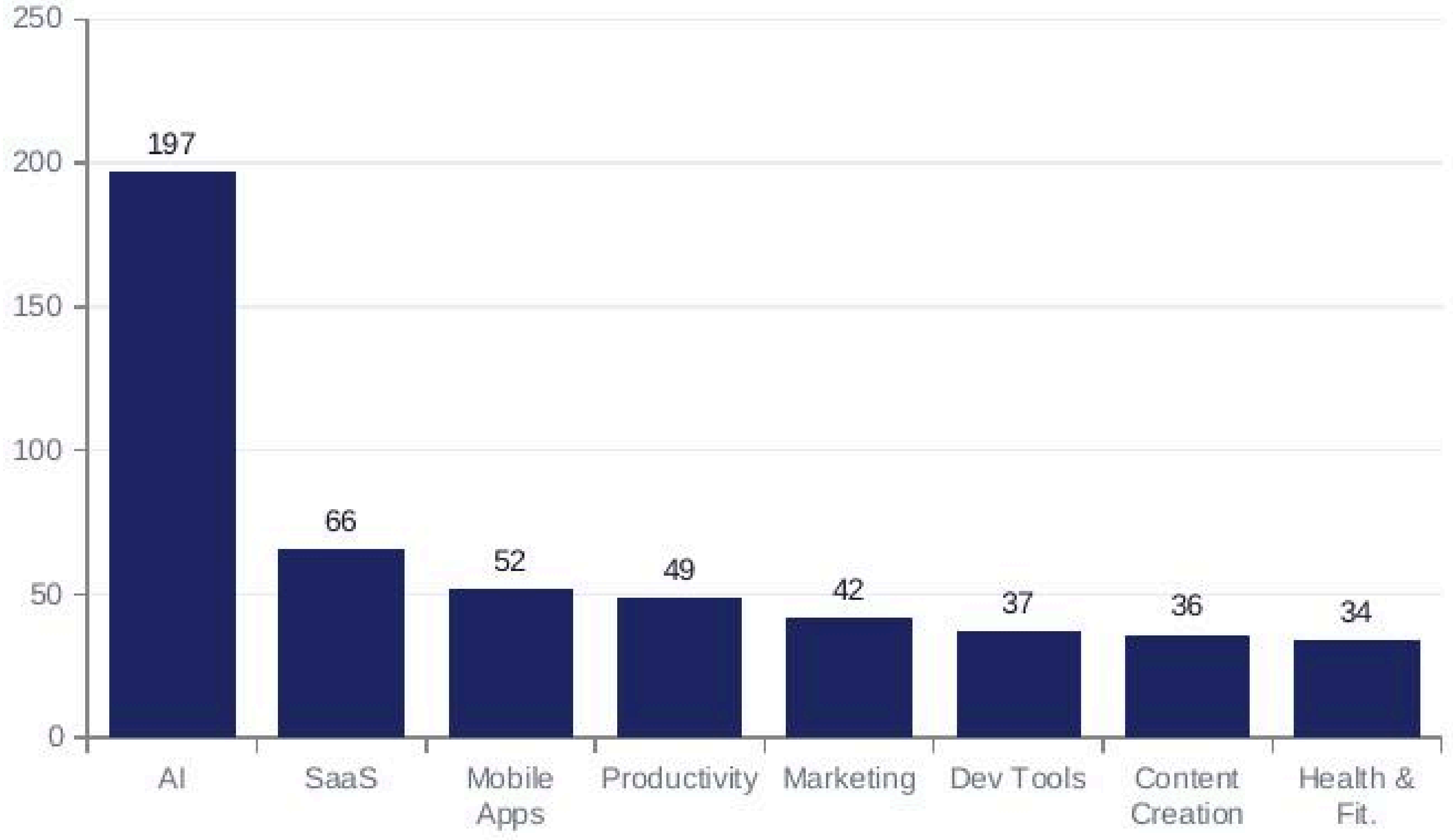
TrustMRR Startup Dataset · Snapshot 30 Jul 2026 2

Category Landscape: Crowded ≠ Profitable

Where founders are building vs. where the money concentrates, by category

Listings by category (count)



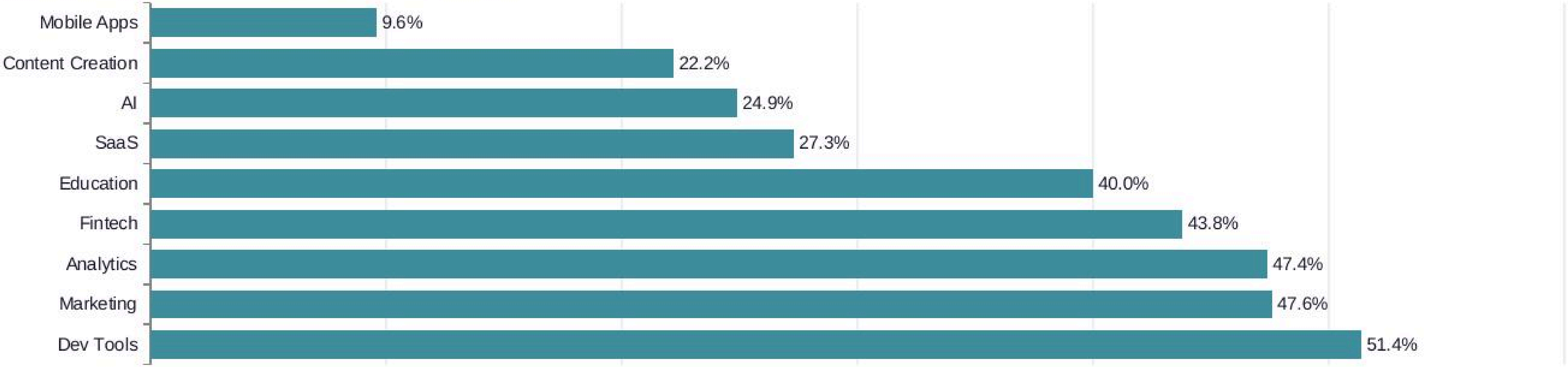
Same categories, ranked by median MRR ($)

AI has 3x more listings than any other category (197) but ranks only 7th of 8 in median MRR ($446). Marketing (42 listings) and Content Creation (36) monetize 3-4x better with far less competition. Outside the top 8 by volume, Education (30 listings) posts the single highest median MRR of the dataset at $2,142 — the clearest crowded-vs-profitable mismatch in the data.

Momentum vs. Monetization

Which categories are growing right now — and whether that growth is worth chasing

Share of startups with positive 30-day MRR growth (%)

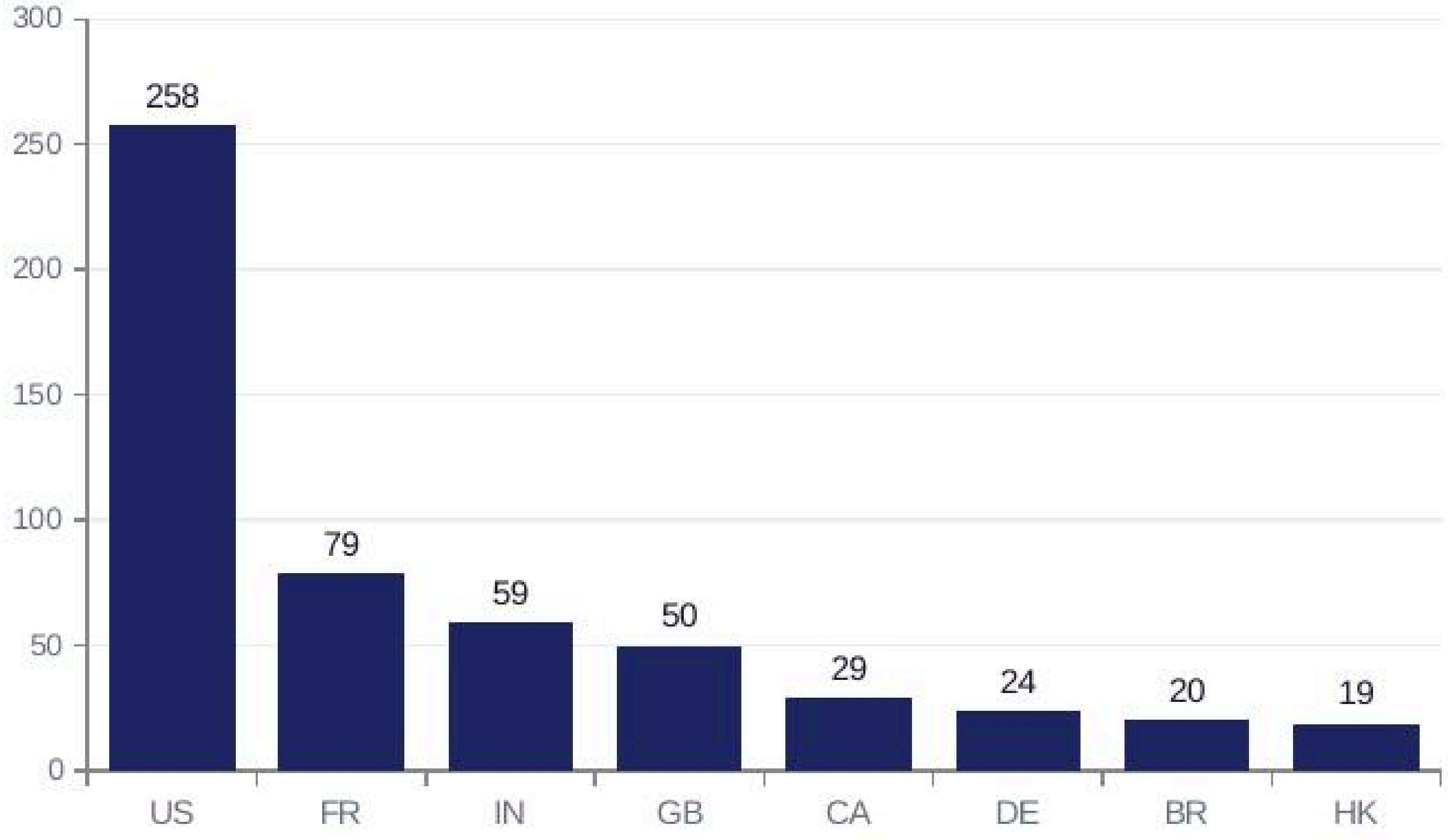


Dev Tools has the most momentum — 51% of listings are growing MRR month over month — but also one of the lowest payoffs ($185 median MRR). Fintech and Analytics are the rare combination: top-3 for growth AND top-4 for median MRR, making them the strongest build/acquire targets. Mobile Apps is the warning sign: 52 listings, but only 9.6% growing — largely stagnant despite its size.

Geography: Where the Revenue Is

Volume and revenue quality don't always move together

Startups by country (top 8 of 65)



Median MRR by country ($)

US	**$1,263**	Deepest market — volume + revenue
CA	**$919**	Small but high-value base
BR	**$666**	Emerging, above-median value
FR	**$435**	High volume, modest MRR
DE	**$230**	Steady mid-tier
GB	**$153**	High volume, lower MRR
IN	**$6**	Highest volume of low-MRR listings
HK	**$0**	Early-stage / pre-revenue cluster

The US leads on both dimensions — most listings (258) and highest median MRR ($1,263) — making it the priority market for building and acquiring. India drives volume (59 startups) but at a near-zero median MRR of $6, pointing to a much earlier-stage or lower-price-point founder cohort rather than a comparable market.

B2B vs. B2C: Where Dollars Concentrate

Fewer B2B startups, but each one earns dramatically more per company and per customer

B2C

401 startups

Median MRR

$181

Median rev / visitor

$0.26

Median ARPU / subscriber

$9.34

B2B

255 startups

Median MRR

$1,036

Median rev / visitor

$0.90

Median ARPU / subscriber

$49.00

Both

56 startups

Median MRR

$352

Median rev / visitor

$0.04

Median ARPU / subscriber

$17.37

B2B startups earn ~5.7x the median MRR of B2C, monetize traffic ~3.5x better per visitor, and charge each subscriber ~5.2x more per month ($49 vs $9.34 ARPU) — despite being outnumbered 401 to 255. B2C is the more crowded lane; B2B is where dollars concentrate, both per company and per customer.

Authority Signal: Domain Rating Tracks Revenue

A simple SEO metric turns out to be a meaningful proxy for monetization

r = 0.54

correlation between domain rating
and log(MRR) across listings
with both fields reported

- **A moderate, not spurious, relationship**

  0.54 is a meaningful positive correlation for a single non-financial variable — well above what noise alone would produce across ~700 listings with both fields present.

- **Backlink profile as a cheap due-diligence signal**

  For acquisition screening, domain rating is public, free to check, and available even when a seller hasn't shared full financials — useful as a first-pass filter before requesting Stripe access.

- **Content and SEO categories look under-monetized relative to authority**

  Content Creation (36 listings, $1,254 median MRR) already shows this pattern paying off — authority-building categories convert traffic into revenue more reliably than paid-acquisition-heavy ones.

Domain rating explains a real share of MRR variation in this dataset. It won't replace revenue diligence, but it's a fast, free signal worth pulling into any first-pass acquisition screen alongside asking price and MRR.

Acquisition Screening

Filtering the for-sale listings down to cheap, growing startups

262

Listings currently for sale

26% of all startups

224

Have both an asking price and positive MRR

usable for screening

38 mo

Median payback period

asking price ÷ MRR, across those 224

6

Flagged "Cheap + Growing"

payback under 12 months AND positive MRR growth

The 6 "Cheap + Growing" listings

Startup	Category	MRR	Asking Price	Payback	MRR Growth (30d)
Reloop	Marketing	$1,119	$5,000	4.5 mo	+24.3%
Linkeddit	Sales	$1,036	$5,000	4.8 mo	+90.1%
JuggleHire	Recruiting & HR	$1,817	$12,000	6.6 mo	+9.6%
Leadbomb	SaaS	$3,633	$25,000	6.9 mo	+38.9%
Delta Sports	SaaS	$1,076	$10,000	9.3 mo	+19.9%
Kickly (Pronos IA)	Games	$10,236	$100,000	9.8 mo	+384.5%

How to use this: start with these six — they clear their purchase price in under a year of current MRR and are still growing. Marketplace listings move fast; verify current asking price and status before any conversation.

Recommendations

Five moves this data supports directly

1. **Target under-crowded, high-value categories — and prioritize B2B**

   Education, Marketing, and Analytics post the highest median MRR with a fraction of AI's listing volume; B2B commands ~5.7x the MRR and ~5x the per-subscriber price of B2C.

2. **Chase categories with both momentum and payoff**

   Fintech and Analytics combine top-tier growth (44-47% of listings growing) with top-tier median MRR — a stronger signal than growth or size alone.

3. **Anchor on the US; treat India and the UK as volume, not value, plays**

   The US leads on both listing count and median MRR ($1,263). India shows high volume but near-zero median MRR ($6), pointing to a different-stage cohort.

4. **Add domain rating to first-pass acquisition screening**

   A 0.54 correlation with MRR makes it a free, public signal worth checking before requesting financials on a target.

5. **Screen acquisitions on payback period, not sticker price — then verify**

   Start with the 6 listings under 12-month payback and still growing; re-confirm pricing and status before any conversation, since listings move fast.